English Full-Marks Guide

Simple, complete, and built for tomorrow's paper. Read each module once, then do the recall checks without looking. Answers are at the end of each module.

How to use this in 45 minutes: Module 1 and 2 (10 min), Module 3 (12 min), Module 4 and 5 (12 min), Scenario drill (11 min). Say each Golden Line out loud twice.

Module 1: Communication Basics and Confidence

1.1 Why communication matters

- **Academics and projects:** clear communication stops misunderstandings and scope creep (doing work nobody asked for).
- **Teamwork:** it lets people give feedback openly and split tasks fairly.
- **Internships and placements:** it shows maturity and helps you pass interviews.

1.2 Barriers and simple fixes

Barrier	What it does	Fix
Confidence / hesitation	You freeze. Spotlight effect: you think everyone is watching your mistakes. They are not.	Focus on the message, not on yourself.
Fear of judgment	You stop talking at all.	Treat talk as a back-and-forth exchange, not a per
Language anxiety	You try hard words and get stuck.	Use simple, clear words first.
Assumptions	You guess what the other person means.	Ask a check question: 'So you mean...?'
Lack of preparation	You ramble or forget key points.	Spend 2 minutes planning your 3 main points first.

1.3 The communication process (know all 7 parts)

- **Sender:** the person who starts the message.
- **Message:** what is being said.
- **Channel:** how it travels (email, call, slides, chat).
- **Receiver:** the person who gets it.
- **Feedback:** the receiver's reply, which tells the sender if the message landed.
- **Context:** the situation, place, and relationship around the message. Same words mean different things in different contexts.
- **Noise:** anything that blocks the message (bad signal, a rude tone, distractions, jargon).

Key idea: communication is a loop, not a one-way push. Feedback closes the loop.

1.4 Three parts that create meaning

- **Verbal:** the words you choose. Keep them short and clear.
- **Nonverbal:** eye contact, posture, distance, and voice (pitch, speed, and tone).
- **Listening:** not just hearing. Active listening means you paraphrase ('You're saying...'), ask questions, and notice feelings.

Recall check 1: (a) Name the 7 parts of the communication process. (b) What is 'noise'? (c) Why is feedback important? (d) Name the three parts that create meaning. (e) Give one fix for 'fear of judgment'.
Answers: (a) sender, message, channel, receiver, feedback, context, noise (b) anything that blocks the message (c) it shows if the message was understood (d) verbal, nonverbal, listening (e) treat it as an exchange, not a performance.

Module 2: Public Speaking

2.1 Stage fear: what happens and what to do

Stage fear is your body's fight-or-flight reaction. You may feel a fast heartbeat, sweaty hands, a dry mouth, or fast breathing. This energy is normal. Use it, do not fight it.

- **Breathing reset:** breathe in through the belly for 4 seconds, out for 6 seconds. Repeat 3 times before you start.
- **Simple reminder:** the audience wants you to succeed. Most people are thinking about themselves.

2.2 Plan before you speak (the AIM steps)

- **Audience:** who are they, what do they already know, what might they doubt?
- **Intent:** what should they think, feel, or do after you finish?
- **Message:** one main idea (your thesis) that you repeat through the whole talk.
- **Level of detail:** give enough detail to prove your point, but not so much that people get lost. Use 2 or 3 supporting points, not 10.

2.3 Structure: opening, body, close

- **Opening:** do not start with 'Hello, my name is...'. Start with a question, a surprising fact, or a short story. Then state your main idea.
- **Body:** 2 or 3 connected points. Link them with signposts: 'First...', 'Next...', 'The main reason is...'.
- **Close:** summarise the main idea in one sentence and end with a clear action or thought. Do not just stop.

2.4 The What? So What? Now What? method

- **What?** the facts or the topic. Example: 'We built a new study app.'
- **So What?** why it matters. Example: 'It saves each student about an hour a week.'
- **Now What?** the action you want. Example: 'Please approve a pilot test next week.'

2.5 Preparation, notes, and recovery

- **Rehearse out loud** at least 2 times. Time yourself.
- **Use keyword notes**, not full scripts. Scripts stop eye contact and make your voice flat.
- **If you lose your thread:** pause for 2 seconds, say your last clear point again, then continue. Do not over-apologise.

Recall check 2: (a) What should you do with stage-fear energy? (b) Name the 4 AIM steps. (c) What is a good opening? (d) What does 'So What?' answer? (e) What do you do if you lose your thread?
Answers: (a) use it, do not fight it (b) audience, intent, message, level of detail (c) a question, surprising fact, or short story (d) why it matters (e) pause 2 seconds and restate your last clear point.

Module 3: Professional Emails and Clear Writing

3.1 The 7 parts of a professional email

Part	What to write	Example phrase
1. Subject line	Clear, short, action first	[Request] Project Alpha report extension
2. Context	Why you are writing (one sentence)	I am writing about the Project Alpha report.
3. Request (CTA)	Exactly what you need	I would like a 48-hour extension.
4. Supporting detail	Short reasons, dates, numbers	We found a database bug that needs re-testing.
5. Next step	Date, time, or who does what	We will submit by 2 November at 5 PM.

6. Attachment reference	Name the file	I have attached the preliminary modules (Alpha_v2.pdf).
7. Sign-off	Polite closing and your name	Thank you. Regards, [Name, Roll No.]

3.2 Writing for a busy reader

- Maximum 3 sentences per paragraph.
- Use bullets when you list 3 or more items.
- Put the most important point first.

3.3 Fix the bad language (before and after)

Type of bad language	Bad	Better
Inflated	Please be advised that we are utilising our resources to effectuate a rapid solution.	We are fixing the issue now.
Passive-aggressive	As per my previous email...	To keep our timeline on track, could you reply by Fri
Too formal	I hereby wish to inform you that I shall be unable to attend.	I will not be able to attend.
Unintentionally rude	You did not send the file.	The file has not reached me yet. Could you resend i
Vague	Soon, maybe.	By Thursday, 5 PM.

3.4 Model emails for the situations your teacher listed

Extension request: Subject: [Extension Request] Project Alpha report. Dear Dr. Aris, I am writing to request a 48-hour extension for the Project Alpha report, due on 30 October. We found a database bug that needs re-testing. I have attached the completed modules for your review. We will submit by 2 November, 5 PM. Thank you. Regards, [Name]

Delay notice: Subject: [Update] Delay in Lab Report. Dear Ma'am, the lab report will be late by one day because the data set was corrupted. I will submit it tomorrow by 11 AM. Sorry for the delay. Regards, [Name]

Asking for help: Subject: [Help Needed] Maths assignment question 3. Dear Sir, I am stuck on question 3 of the assignment. I have tried the integration method but my answer does not match the key. Could you show me which step I should check? Thank you. Regards, [Name]

Admitting a mistake: Subject: [Correction] Attendance sheet error. Dear Ma'am, I found a mistake in the attendance sheet I sent this morning. Two roll numbers were swapped. I have corrected it and attached the updated sheet. Sorry for the error. Regards, [Name]

Reminder: Subject: [Reminder] Feedback on project proposal. Dear Dr. Rao, I wanted to follow up on my proposal sent on 15 October. If you can share feedback by Friday, we can start the next phase on Monday. Thank you. Regards, [Name]

Polite refusal: Subject: [Response] Invitation to join the event. Dear Priya, thank you for inviting me. I am unable to join on Saturday because of an exam. I hope the event goes well. Regards, [Name]

3.5 Email or call?

- **Email:** you need a written record, you are attaching files, or the message is not urgent.
- **Call:** the topic is emotional (a conflict), confusing, or needs quick back-and-forth brainstorming.

Recall check 3: (a) Name the 7 email parts in order. (b) Max sentences per paragraph? (c) Fix: 'As per my previous email.' (d) Give the one-line subject for a reminder. (e) Email or call for a heated disagreement?
Answers: (a) subject, context, request, supporting detail, next step, attachment, sign-off (b) 3 (c) 'Could you reply by Friday?' style (d) start with [Reminder] and name the topic (e) call.

Module 4: Presentations

4.1 Presentation vs written document

A written report can be dense because the reader controls the speed. A presentation is for the audience to follow your pace and feel your message. Slides are visual support, not a printed document.

4.2 Hold attention

- **Hook:** a shocking number, a counter-intuitive question, or a short story.
- **Rule of One:** each slide has one main takeaway.
- **Examples:** a real example makes an idea stick better than a definition.

4.3 Slides: how to use them

- Maximum about 10 slides for a 20-minute talk (the 10-20-30 idea, from Guy Kawasaki).
- Titles at least 30 pt. Under 25 words per slide.
- Do not read from slides. Slides support you; you do the explaining.
- Use one simple chart per slide, not two or three.

4.4 Transitions (linking your points)

- 'Now that we have seen the problem, let us look at the solution.'
- 'This leads to my second point...'
- 'Before I move on, let me sum up...'

4.5 Impromptu speaking: the PREP method

- **P** Point: state your answer first.
- **R** Reason: why you think so.
- **E** Example: a real case or a number.
- **P** Point: restate your answer to finish.

4.6 Q&A protocol

- Listen to the full question. Do not interrupt.
- Pause for 1 second to organise your answer.
- Confirm the intent: 'So you are asking about...?'
- Answer directly, using one fact or example.
- Bridge back: 'That links to my main point, which is...'
- If you do not know: 'I do not have that data now, but I can check and send it to you.' Never guess.

Recall check 4: (a) How many slides for 20 minutes? (b) Min slide title size? (c) What does PREP stand for? (d) Give one transition. (e) What do you say if you do not know an answer?
Answers: (a) about 10 (b) 30 pt (c) Point, Reason, Example, Point (d) 'Before I move on, let me sum up...' (e) 'I will check and send it to you.'

Module 5: Workplace Messages and Tone

5.1 Choose the right channel

Channel	Use it for	Expected reply
Email	External pitches, formal contracts, records	Within 24 working hours
Direct message	Urgent one-to-one questions	1 to 2 hours
Public channel	Team-wide updates and announcements	By end of the working day
Thread	Discussion on one post (keeps the main feed clean)	As needed

Call	Blockers, escalations, sensitive feedback	Immediately (sync)

5.2 Urgency, working hours and follow-ups

- Mark urgency clearly, for example: 'Urgent: needed by 3 PM today.'
- Do not send urgent messages late at night unless it is an emergency.
- Follow up once after the expected reply time has passed. Be polite: 'Just checking in on this.'

5.3 Status update: 4 parts

- **Work completed:** what you finished, with numbers if possible.
- **Current obstacle:** what is slowing you down.
- **Support needed:** the exact person or resource you need.
- **Next step:** your next priority and when you will do it.

5.4 Threads, decisions and tagging

- Keep discussion inside a thread so the main channel stays clear.
- At the end of a long thread, post a summary: 'Decision: we will use Option B. Owner: Riya. Due: Monday.'
- Tag only the people who must act. Too many tags make everyone ignore the message.

5.5 Tone templates

- **Mistake:** 'I found a calculation error in the Q3 sheet I sent this morning. I have fixed it. The updated sheet is linked below.'
- **Competing priorities:** 'I have two urgent tasks today. I will finish the marketing deck by 2 PM and the analysis by 6 PM. Let me know if the order should change.'
- **Refusal:** 'I cannot take this on this week because of my current deadlines. I can help next Monday.'
- **Asking for help:** 'I am stuck on X. Could you spare 15 minutes to look at it with me?'

Recall check 5: (a) Expected reply time for email? (b) What are the 4 parts of a status update? (c) How do you end a long thread? (d) Give one refusal phrase. (e) Why avoid too many tags?
Answers: (a) within 24 working hours (b) work completed, obstacle, support needed, next step (c) post a decision summary with owner and due date (d) 'I cannot take this on this week...' (e) people stop reading the message.

Scenario and Application Drill

Exam questions often describe a situation and ask what you would write or say. Use this 4-step method every time:

- **Step 1: Who and why?** Identify the receiver and the purpose (request, apology, update, persuade).
- **Step 2: Choose the channel.** Formal record = email. Urgent or emotional = call. Team-wide = public channel.
- **Step 3: Use the structure.** Email: 7 parts. Speech: opening, 2 or 3 points, close. Status: 4 parts.
- **Step 4: Check the tone.** Polite, clear, short, and no blame.

Practice questions (try first, then read the model answer)

Q1. Your group project partner has not shared the code. Write a message.
Model: 'Hi Aman, I have not received the code yet. Could you share it by 6 PM today so I can test it before tomorrow's review? Thanks.'

Q2. You missed a class. Write an email to the teacher asking for notes.
Model: Subject: [Request] Notes for Monday's class. Dear Ma'am, I was absent on Monday because I was unwell. Could you share the notes or the topics covered? I will study them before the next class. Thank you. Regards, [Name]

Q3. Your presentation runs 5 minutes over time. What do you do?
Model: Skip one example, shorten the close to one sentence, and move on quickly. Say: 'Let me quickly sum up.' Do not panic or apologise at length.

Q4. A classmate is angry at you for a mistake. Call or email?
Model: Call (or meet). Emotional stakes are high, so a call lets you listen and clarify. Then send a short email summary if a record is needed.

Q5. Someone asks a question you cannot answer in a presentation.
Model: 'That is a good question. I do not have the exact figure now. I will check and send it to you by tomorrow.'

Q6. Write a status update for your team: you finished the UI but the API is blocked.
Model: *Completed:* Finished the login UI (3 screens). *Obstacle:* API endpoint is not responding. *Support:* Could Ravi check the server by noon? *Next step:* Connect the UI once the API works.

Q7. Persuade your teacher to change a deadline by one day.
Model: Use What? So What? Now What?: 'The lab data needs one more test (What). This ensures accurate results for the report (So What). Could I submit one day later, on Friday? (Now What)'

Q8. Your 3-minute speech on 'Why Sleep Matters' needs an opening.
Model: 'Students who sleep 4 hours before an exam often forget what they studied. Today I will show you why sleep is part of your study plan.' (Surprising fact plus a clear main idea.)

Golden Lines (memorise these)

- Communication is a loop: sender, message, channel, receiver, feedback, context, noise.
- Stage fear is energy. Breathe in for 4, out for 6.
- Plan: Audience, Intent, Message, Level of detail.
- Email: subject, context, request, detail, next step, attachment, sign-off.
- Maximum 3 sentences per paragraph. Bullets for 3 or more items.
- Presentation: 10 slides, 20 minutes, titles 30 pt, one takeaway per slide.
- PREP: Point, Reason, Example, Point.

- Status: completed, obstacle, support, next step.
- Unknown answer: 'I will check and send it to you.'
- Long thread: end with a decision, owner, and due date.

Final Self-Test (no looking back)

- Write a 7-part email asking for a deadline extension in 10 lines.
- Give a 3-part speech opening with a question, a point, and a close.
- Rewrite: 'Please be advised that we are utilising our resources.'
- Give PREP for: 'Should college have a 4-day week?'
- Write a 4-part status update for your last project task.

Note on sources: the frameworks above are commonly taught communication methods. Where your teacher's notes name a source, use their wording in the exam. Do not invent citations.